











NICOLA HOOD

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INFO

The Nicola Hood is an oversized hood-style balaclava worked seamlessly top down in a combination of stockinette and garter stitch.

First, you work a seamless cast on and begin to work flat for a few rounds. Once the hood is long enough to fit your head, you begin to work the dickie section, which is first knit in garter stitch in the round and then flat to perfectly cover your neck. Afterwards, you pick up sts for the hood opening and work a few rounds of ribbing, which is then folded and finished with an i-cord or velvet ribbon closure.

TIP! A variegated, speckled or tweedy yarn base will elevate this design to 'effortless basic with a twist' category.

MEASUREMENTS

Neck circumference: 32.5 cm (13")

Hood opening: 30 cm (12")

YARN

One strand of *Rachel* (100% merino 400m/100g) held together with *Elisabeth* (72% kid mohair, 28% silk 420m/50g).

Both by Aitana Villa in colorway Paris.

Or

370 meters of fingering-weight yarn held together with the same amount of lace-weight mohair or alpaca.

NEEDLES

— 4 mm / US 6 circular needle, cable length 40 cm / 16" (or needle size to obtain gauge).

— 3.5 mm / US 4 circular needle, cable length 40 cm / 16" (or needle size to obtain gauge).

GAUGE

21 sts x 30 rows = 10 x 10 cm / 4 x 4" in stockinette stitch on larger needle after blocking.

NOTIONS

Blocking tools, darning needle, stitch counter, stitch markers, and tape measure.

Velvet Ribbon (100 cm length) and two metal cord closures.

SUPPORT

For support, questions and love letters, you can reach out at vanessa@vanessapellisa.com.

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ABBREVIATIONS

BOR: beginning of round

CO: cast on

K: knit

K2TOG: knit 2 sts together (1 st dec'd)

M: marker

M1L: make 1 left-leaning stitch (1 st inc'd)

M1R: make 1 right-leaning stitch (1 st inc'd)

P: purl

P2TOG: purl 2 sts together (1 st dec'd)

RS: right side

SL: slip

SM: slip marker

SSK/SSP: slip, slip, knit / purl (1 st dec'd)

ST(S): stitch(es)

WS: wrong side

WYIF: with yarn in front

WYIB: with yarn in back

YO: yarn over

Instructions

SET-UP AND CAST ON



Video support: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ycre5-i5zzM>

With gauge-size needles (for my sample, 4 mm / US 6 needles were used), and both yarns held together, cast-on 80 sts with Judy's Magic Cast On but do not join to work in the round. Turn work.

SET-UP ROW 1 (WS): sl1 wyif, purl 38 sts, place marker, purl 2, place marker, purl 39 sts.

SET-UP ROW 2 (RS): sl1 wyib, knit to marker, M1L, sm, K2, sm, M1R, knit to end. (2 sts inc'd, 82 sts)

MAIN SECTION

ROW 1 (WS): sl1 wyif, purl to end, slipping markers as they appear.

ROW 2 (RS): sl1 wyib, knit to marker, M1L, sm, K2, sm, M1R, knit to end. (2 sts inc'd, 84 sts)

Repeat rows 1 and 2 until there are 106 sts on the needles.

Then, remove the markers and work as follows:

ROW 1 (WS): sl1 wyif, purl to end.

ROW 2 (RS): sl1 wyib, knit to end.

Repeat the last two rounds until the hood measures 30 cm /12" from CO. If you wish to create a longer or shorter hood opening, I suggest you modify the length here.

Then, work as follows

ROW 1 (WS): sl1 wyif, purl to end.

ROW 2 (RS): sl1 wyib, knit 4, M1R, knit to 5 sts to end, M1L, K5. (2 sts inc'd. 108 sts)

Repeat the last two rounds 4 more times ending in a repeat of row 1. There are 116 sts on the needles.

Now, join both edges to begin to work in the round, as follows.



Video support: Backward loop cast-on <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/BfqdAMWUaP4>

NEXT ROUND: sl1 wyib, knit to end, CO 8 sts with the backward loop cast-on method, join to work in the round and k27. Place BOR m. (124 sts)

NECK

The neck is worked in garter stitch, which will lay flat around your neck and chest. Change to below gauge needle (for my sample, I used 3.5 mm needles).

Knit 4 rounds. Then, work as follows.

ROUND 1: purl to end.

ROUND 2: knit to end.

Repeat the last two rounds 4 more times and then one more repeat of ROUND 1. Then, begin to work flat as follows.

NEXT ROW (RS): knit to 1 st to BOR, BO 1 st, turn work. *(1 st dec'd. 123 sts)*

NEXT ROW (WS): sl1 wyif, knit 59 sts, BO 1 st, turn work. *(1 st dec'd. 122 sts)*

Leave the remaining back sts on hold using some waste yarn or a stitch holder.

You are now working the front flat.

NEXT ROW (RS): Sl1wyib, sl1 wyif, k1, yo, ssk, knit to 5 sts to end, k2tog, yo, K1, sl1 wyif, p1.

NEXT ROW (WS): Sl1wyib, k1, sl1 wyif. Drop the yo. Knit to last 4 sts. Drop the yo. Sl1wyif, k1, p1.

Repeat the last two rows until there are 14 sts on the needles.

NEXT ROW (RS): Sl1wyib, sl1 wyif, k1, knit to 3 sts to end, K1, sl1 wyif, p1.

NEXT ROW (WS): Sl1wyib, k1, sl1 wyif, knit to 3 sts to end, sl1 wyif, k1, p1.

NEXT ROW (RS): Sl1wyib, sl1 wyif, k1, *(return last 3 sts to left hand needle, knit 2, k2tog. Return last 3 sts to left hand needle, sl1 wyib, sl1 wyif, k2tog.) Repeat from * to 3 sts to end, join ends using kitchener stitch.

BACK NECK

Now place the sts on hold back on the needles.

Begin work at the WS.

NEXT ROW (WS): Sl1 wyib, k1, sl1wyif, SSK, knit to last 5 sts, K2tog, Sl1 wyif, K1, P1.

NEXT ROW (RS): Sl1 wyib, sl1 wyif, K1, double yo, SSK, knit to last 5 sts, K2tog, double yo, K1, sl1 wyif, P1.

NEXT ROW (WS): Sl1 wyib, k1, sl1 wyif. Drop the 2 yos. SSK, knit to last 5 sts, K2tog, Drop the 2 yos. Sl1 wyif, K1, P1.

Repeat until there are 8 sts on the needles.

NEXT ROW (RS): Sl1 wyib, sl1 wyif, k1, knit to 3 sts to end, K1, sl1 wyif, p1.

NEXT ROW (WS): Sl1 wyib, k1, sl1 wyif. knit to 3 sts to end. Sl1wyif, k1, p1.

NEXT ROW (RS): Sl1 wyib, sl1 wyif, k1, *(return last 3 sts to left hand needle, knit 2, k2tog. Return last 3 sts to left hand needle, sl1 wyib, sl1 wyif, k2tog.) Repeat from * to 3 sts to end and join ends using kitchener stitch.

I-CORD CORD / LEATHER CORD / FABRIC RIBBON

For my sample, I used a 100 cm long velvet ribbon and two metal closures to tie the hood. You can also use a knitted i-cord (a 4 stitch i-cord of 95 cm of length would be perfect!) You may adjust the length to your liking, it should be at least 20 cm (8") longer than the actual hood opening.

HOOD OPENING

Tip! You could work the ribbed edge in a contrasting color.

Starting at the center of the CO sts at the lower part of the hood opening, and on the second column next to the actual edge column of sts, with below gauge-needle size (for our sample, 3.5 mm needles were used), pick up 3 out of 4 stitches throughout the opening of the hood, and make sure to get an even number of sts. Join to work in the round and place a marker to indicate BOR. For reference, I picked up 202 sts.

ROUNDS 1-4: *(K1, p1). Repeat from * to end.

ROUND 5: (K1, p1) x 2, k1, BO 2 sts. Then, *(P1, K1) from * to 7 sts to end, BO 2 sts, continue working in established ribbing to end. (*4 sts dec'd*).

ROUND 6: (K1, P1) to gap, CO 2 sts using the backward loop cast-on method, resume working in ribbing to gap, CO 2 sts using the backward loop cast-on method, continue working in ribbing to end.

ROUND 7-10: *(K1, p1). Repeat from * to end.



Video support: fold line https://youtu.be/KzK_y-3_MXo

ROUND 11: *(K1, sl1 purlwise wyif). Repeat from * to end.

ROUND 12: *(sl1 knitwise wyib, P1). Repeat from * to end.

ROUND 11-13: *(K1, sl1 purlwise wyif). Repeat from * to end.

ROUND 14: *(K1, p1). Repeat from * to end.

Repeat the last round 9 more times.

Slip the cord or ribbon inside the edge and through the eyelets and fold the rib edge double towards the inside of the hood to seam it and bind it off as follows.



Video support: <https://youtu.be/eRXDabcDSeg>

BIND OFF ROUND: *(Pick up 1 stitch from the round where stitches were picked and place it on the left-hand needle. Knit this stitch together with the first stitch on the left-hand needle. Now, pass the second stitch on the right-hand needle over it (you have just BO 1 st). Now K1 stitch. Now, pass the 2nd stitch on the right-hand needle over the stitch that you just knit.) Repeat from * to end of the round.

FINISHING

Weave in ends and block to measurements. You can block the top of the hood with a round plate to help it achieve a round shape at the top!

Congratulations on finishing your beautiful hand-made hood!

THANK YOU!

Thank you so much for getting a copy of this pattern. I hope that you will enjoy knitting it. My designs are created from the heart and I hope you will get plenty of wear out of the garments that you create with them.

If you are on Instagram, you can share your project using the hashtag #NicolaTheHood and tagging me @vanessapellisa, so I can find you!

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